

TEND

1. Passage anchor

> “At that time, I was quite shy and **tended to keep my head down in class**.”

Passage meaning

****tend to do something**** = usually or often behave in a particular way; have a general tendency to do something

****往往會；通常會；傾向於****

So:

****I tended to keep my head down in class.****

= ****我以前在課堂上往往會低著頭。****

= ****我當時在課堂上通常比較低調，不太敢表現自己。****

Practice

1. I ****tend to get nervous**** before presentations.

我在簡報前****往往會緊張****。

2. She ****tends to speak quietly**** when she meets new people.

她遇到陌生人時****通常會說得比較小聲****。

Core meanings of TEND

2. tend to do something — usually behave or happen in a particular way

= regularly or characteristically do something, although not necessarily every time

****往往會；通常會；傾向於****

This is by far the most important everyday meaning.

Examples

1. People ****tend to feel tired**** after a long flight.

人們坐完長途飛機後****往往會感到疲倦****。

2. He ****tends to avoid conflict**** whenever possible.

只要可以，他****通常會避免衝突****。

Key idea

****tend to**** expresses a ****general pattern****, not a certainty.

If someone ****tends to be late****, it means they are often late—not that they are late every single time.

3. tend to be + adjective

= generally or characteristically have a certain quality

****往往是.....的；通常比較.....****

Examples

1. Winters here ****tend to be mild****.

這裡的冬天****通常比較溫和****。

2. Young children ****tend to be curious****.

年幼的孩子****通常很好奇****。

This is one of the most frequent patterns:

****subject + tend to be + adjective****

4. tend to + verb

= have a habitual or common tendency to perform an action

****常常會.....；往往會.....****

Examples

1. I ****tend to forget names****.

我****常常會忘記別人的名字****。

2. She ****tends to overthink things****.

她****往往會把事情想得太多****。

Common learner combinations:

* tend to forget

* tend to worry

* tend to avoid

* tend to prefer

- * tend to happen
- * tend to increase
- * tend to become

5. something tends to happen

= something commonly or generally happens under certain conditions

****某事往往會發生；通常會出現****

Here, the subject does not have to be a person.

Examples

1. Accidents ****tend to happen**** when people are tired.
人們疲倦時，意外****往往容易發生****。
2. Prices ****tend to rise**** during periods of high demand.
在需求高的時期，價格****通常會上升****。

This is extremely common in:

- * academic writing
- * IELTS writing
- * scientific description
- * generalizations

6. tend toward / towards something

= show a tendency to develop, move, or change in a particular direction

****趨向；傾向於；朝.....發展****

Examples

1. His opinions ****tend toward the conservative side****.
他的看法****較傾向保守****。
2. As people age, sleep patterns may ****tend toward greater irregularity****.
隨著年齡增長，睡眠模式可能****趨向更不規律****。

This is more formal than ****tend to do****.

7. tend toward / towards + noun or state

= gradually lean toward a particular quality, condition, or result

趨於；偏向

Examples

1. The discussion **tended toward negativity**.

討論逐漸**偏向負面**。

2. His writing **tends towards simplicity**.

他的寫作風格**傾向簡潔**。

Common abstract nouns:

* simplicity

* caution

* pessimism

* stability

* extremity

* informality

TEND as “care for”

8. tend someone / something

= look after, care for, or attend to someone or something

照料；照顧；照管

This is a genuinely different meaning from **tend to = usually**.

It is less common in everyday conversational English, but still established.

Examples

1. Nurses **tended the injured passengers**.

護士**照料受傷的乘客**。

2. He stayed home to **tend his sick mother**.

他留在家裡**照顧生病的母親**。

This use often sounds somewhat literary, formal, or traditional.

9. tend a garden / crops / plants

= care for plants, crops, or land regularly

照料；照管；栽培

Examples

1. She spends every morning **tending her garden**.

她每天早上都會**照料自己的花園**。

2. Farmers were **tending the crops** in the fields.

農民正在田裡**照料作物**。

Common objects:

* garden

* plants

* crops

* fields

* vines

10. tend animals / livestock

= take care of animals

照料；看管（牲畜等）

Examples

1. He spent the afternoon **tending the sheep**.

他整個下午都在**照料羊群**。

2. Workers **tend the animals** every morning.

工作人員每天早上都會**照顧那些動物**。

This use is especially associated with farming and animal care.

11. tend a fire

= look after a fire by adding fuel or keeping it burning properly

照看火堆；添柴維持火勢

Examples

1. Someone had to stay awake to **tend the fire**.
必須有人保持清醒來**照看火堆**。
2. He quietly **tended the fire** throughout the night.
他整夜安靜地**照料火堆、添柴維持火勢**。

This is a conventional use of the care-taking sense.

12. tend a wound

= care for or treat an injury

處理傷口；照料傷勢

Examples

1. The medic **tended his wound** immediately.
醫護人員立即**處理他的傷口**。
2. She helped **tend the injured man's wounds**.
她幫忙**照料那名傷者的傷口**。

This use overlaps with medical **treat**, but **tend** emphasizes ongoing care and attention.

Important contrast between the two major branches

13. tend to do vs tend someone/something

These are very different.

A. tend to do

= usually / be likely by nature or habit to do

往往；通常；傾向於

- > I **tend to worry** too much.
- > 我**往往會擔心太多**。

B. tend + noun

= care for

****照料；照顧****

> She ****tended the patient****.

> 她****照料那名病人****。

The grammar is a strong clue.

Noun family

14. tendency

= a general inclination, habit, pattern, or likelihood to behave or develop in a certain way

****傾向；趨勢；習性****

Examples

1. He has a ****tendency to interrupt people****.

他有****打斷別人說話的習慣 / 傾向****。

2. There is a growing ****tendency toward online learning****.

****線上學習的趨勢****正在增強。

Common patterns

* tendency to do something

* tendency toward/towards something

* growing tendency

* natural tendency

* strong tendency

15. have a tendency to do something

= regularly be inclined to do something

****有.....的傾向；往往會.....****

Examples

1. She ****has a tendency to worry**** about small things.

她****往往會為小事擔心****。

2. This material ****has a tendency to crack**** in cold weather.

這種材料在寒冷天氣下**容易裂開**。

Compare:

* She **tends to worry**.

* She **has a tendency to worry**.

The second is somewhat more formal and noun-based.

16. tendency toward / towards something

= movement or inclination in a particular direction

朝.....發展的傾向；.....趨勢

Examples

1. There is a clear **tendency toward greater flexibility**.

有一個明顯**朝向更高彈性的趨勢**。

2. The industry shows a **tendency towards consolidation**.

這個產業呈現**整合化的趨勢**。

Common in:

* academic writing

* economics

* social sciences

* formal analysis

Adjectival and related family

17. tending

tending is mainly the present participle / gerund of **tend** rather than a major independent adjective.

Examples:

* **tending a garden** 照料花園

* **tending to complain** 往往會抱怨

It generally does not need to be learned as a separate lexical item.

18. attendant — historically related, but now separate

****attendant**** belongs historically to the same broader “attend/tend” family, but in modern English it functions as a separate lexical item.

Examples:

* flight attendant 空服員

* parking attendant 停車場管理員

For learner curation, it is better treated separately rather than as a normal derivative of ****tend****.

TEND vs similar words

19. tend to vs usually

These often overlap.

usually

= on most occasions

****通常****

tend to

= show a characteristic or general pattern

****往往會；傾向於****

Compare:

> I ****usually drink coffee**** in the morning.

> 我早上****通常喝咖啡****。

This describes frequency.

> I ****tend to drink too much coffee**** when I'm stressed.

> 我壓力大時****往往會喝太多咖啡****。

This emphasizes a behavioral tendency.

20. tend to vs often

****often****

= frequently

****經常****

****tend to****

= characteristically or generally behave in that way

****往往會；傾向於****

Compare:

> He ****often calls me****.

> 他****經常打電話給我****。

> He ****tends to call when he needs help****.

> 他需要幫忙時****往往會打電話來****。

****tend to**** gives more of a pattern or disposition.

21. tend to vs be likely to

They can overlap, but the perspective differs.

tend to

= something generally happens as a pattern

****往往會；傾向於****

be likely to

= something is probable in a particular situation

****很可能會****

Compare:

> Young children ****tend to imitate adults****.

> 年幼的孩子****往往會模仿成年人****。

General pattern.

> He is ****likely to arrive late tonight****.

> 他今晚****很可能會遲到****。

Prediction about a particular event.

22. tend to vs be prone to

tend to

= general tendency, neutral

傾向於；往往會

be prone to

= be especially susceptible to something, often negative

容易.....；易於.....

Compare:

> She **tends to worry**.

> 她**往往會擔心**。

> She is **prone to anxiety**.

> 她**容易焦慮**。

prone to often has a stronger negative or vulnerability sense.

23. tend to vs incline to / be inclined to

be inclined to

= have a preference or disposition toward doing something

傾向於；較願意

tend to

= generally behave or develop in a particular way

往往會

Example:

> I'm **inclined to agree** with you.

> 我**比較傾向同意**你的看法。

This can reflect a current judgment.

> I **tend to agree** with her on these issues.

> 在這些問題上，我**通常比較認同**她。

This sounds more like a recurring pattern.

Academic and IELTS uses

24. tend to + generalization

tend to is especially valuable when making cautious generalizations.

Compare:

> Older people dislike change.

> 老年人不喜歡改變。

This is too absolute.

> Older people **may tend to prefer familiar routines**.

> 年長者**可能較傾向於偏好熟悉的生活模式**。

This is more cautious and academically appropriate.

25. tend to increase / decrease

= generally move upward or downward under certain conditions

往往增加 / 減少；有上升 / 下降趨勢

Examples

1. Stress levels **tend to increase** during exam periods.

考試期間，壓力程度**往往會上升**。

2. Reaction speed **tends to decrease** with fatigue.

疲勞時，反應速度**通常會下降**。

Very useful in IELTS Task 1 and academic writing.

26. tend to occur / appear / arise

= generally occur under particular circumstances

****往往會出現 / 發生****

Examples

1. These problems ****tend to occur**** in older buildings.
這些問題****往往出現在**較老的建築物中。**
2. Errors ****tend to arise**** when instructions are unclear.
指示不清楚時，錯誤****往往會產生**。**

27. tend to favor / prefer

= generally prefer one option or side

****較傾向於；通常偏好****

Examples

1. Younger consumers ****tend to favor**** online services.
年輕消費者****通常比較偏好**線上服務。**
2. I ****tend to prefer**** quieter places.
我****通常比較喜歡**安靜的地方。**

Care-taking family in context

28. tend to someone

There is also an older/formal construction:

****tend to someone/something****

= attend to or take care of

****照顧；處理****

Examples

1. A nurse came to ****tend to the patient****.
一名護士前來****照顧病人**。**
2. I need to ****tend to a few things**** before I leave.

我離開前需要先**處理幾件事情**。

This is important because it looks identical to the common grammatical pattern **tend to + verb**, but it is actually different.

Compare:

* **I tend to worry.**

= 我往往會擔心。

(**to** introduces an infinitive)

* **I need to tend to the patient.**

= 我需要照料病人。

(**to** is a preposition in the expression **tend to someone**)

29. tend to a matter / business / duties

= give necessary attention to something that needs handling

處理；料理；照料

Examples

1. She left early to **tend to some personal business**.

她提早離開去**處理一些私人事務**。

2. He had several urgent matters to **tend to**.

他有幾件緊急事情需要**處理**。

This meaning is close to **attend to**.

Key grammar

30. tend + to-infinitive

Correct:

* tend to worry

* tend to forget

* tend to be quiet

* tend to increase

Pattern:

****subject + tend(s/ed) + to + base verb****

Examples:

* She ****tends to worry****.

* She ****tended to worry****.

* People ****tend to worry****.

31. tense forms

Present

I ****tend to**** stay up late.

我****往往會****熬夜。

Third-person singular

She ****tends to**** stay quiet.

她****往往會****保持安靜。

Past

He ****tended to**** avoid difficult conversations.

他以前****往往會****避免棘手的對話。

Present perfect

She ****has tended to**** work alone.

她一直以來****比較傾向獨自工作****。

32. negative form

****tend not to do something****

= generally do not do something

****通常不會；往往不會****

Examples

1. I ****tend not to eat**** late at night.

我****通常不會****在深夜吃東西。

2. These plants ****tend not to grow well**** in dry soil.

這些植物在乾燥土壤中****通常長得不好****。

This is generally more natural than:

****don't tend to...****

although both occur.

Meaning map

There are two major semantic branches.

Branch A — inclination / direction

****lean or move in a direction****

→ develop in a certain way

→ show a tendency

→ usually behave in a certain way

So:

* tend toward simplicity

* prices tend to rise

* people tend to worry

all involve the idea of ****leaning toward a pattern or outcome****.

Branch B — attention / care

****give attention to something****

→ look after it

→ care for a person, animal, plant, fire, wound, or task

So:

* tend a garden

* tend the sick

* tend a fire

* tend to a problem

share the idea of ****giving necessary care or attention****.

These two branches are sufficiently different that learners should treat them as separate core meanings.

Essential contrasts

tend to do vs be likely to do

****tend to****

= general recurring pattern

****往往會****

****be likely to****

= probability of an event

****很可能會****

> She ****tends to arrive early****.

> 她通常早到。

> She is ****likely to arrive early today****.

> 她今天很可能早到。

tend vs tendency

****tend**** = verb

****傾向於；往往會****

> People ****tend to worry****.

****tendency**** = noun

****傾向；趨勢****

> People have a ****tendency to worry****.

tend vs care for

When meaning “look after,” they often overlap:

> She ****tended the injured man****.

> She ****cared for the injured man****.

But **tend** can sound more formal, literary, occupational, or task-focused.

tend to vs tend to something

Be careful with the grammar:

tend to + verb

> She **tends to complain**.

= 她**往往會抱怨**。

tend to + noun

> She went to **tend to the baby**.

= 她去**照顧嬰兒**。

The same sequence **tend to** can therefore belong to two completely different structures.

Passage recap

> “I was quite shy and **tended to keep my head down in class**.”

Here:

tended to = regularly or characteristically did something in the past

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **往往會**

* **通常會**

* **常常會**

* **傾向於**

In this sentence:

> **I tended to keep my head down in class.**

Natural rendering:

我當時在課堂上往往會低著頭。

In the wider context, ****keep my head down**** also carries the idea that the speaker stayed quiet and tried not to draw attention.

MCQ-ready meaning

****tend to do something****

= ****usually behave in a particular way / generally be likely to do something as a pattern****

****往往會；通常會；有.....的傾向****

It does ****not**** mean “certainly” or “always.” It describes a ****general tendency rather than an absolute rule****.